INCH-POUND

A-A-54706
24 July 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

INDICATOR, STERILIZATION, GAS

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description covers a gas sterilization indicator strip.

Salient characteristics:

Shall be a paper indicator strip which is used to monitor the process of ethylene oxide gas sterilization by distinctive color change, when used as directed inside a surgical pack and subjected to commonly accepted combinations of ethylene oxide gas concentration, humidity, temperature, and time.

Other than the color change, the entire indictor shall be totally unaffected by autoclaving conditions. Smudging, flaking, or any form of physical damage to the indicator shall be unacceptable. The color change and original color must be distinctive enough for the end-user to easily differentiate between gas or steam sterilization indicators.

Indicator strips shall be not less than 3-7/8 inches long and 1/2 inch wide. Each strip shall be imprinted with instructions for use and for positive determination of completed sterilization (exposure).

Workmanship. The gas sterilization indicator shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

AMSC N/A FSC 6530

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Unit. Package (PG). One package containing two hundred (200) or two hundred and fifty (250) indicators, with instructions for use, as specified, constitutes one unit.

QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-2. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one package of indicators.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

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Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction , the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered material. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

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Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	Item Identification
6530-00-079-6994	INDICATOR, STERILIZATION, GAS

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
USPHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6530-2352

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE. This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1 DOCUMENT NUMBER A-A-54706	2 DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD) 24 July 1992

3 DOCUMENT TITLE
INDICATOR, STERILIZATION, GAS

4 NATURE OF CHANGE (*Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.*)

5 REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6 SUBMITTER

a. [redacted]	b. ORGANIZATION
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)
	e. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8 PREPARING ACTIVITY

a NAME Defense Personnel Support Center	b TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (215) 737-2870 (2) AUTOVON 444-2870
c ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) ATTN: MSE 2800 S. 20th Street Philadelphia, PA 19145	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340

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